

University of Washington
Department of Communication

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YIBIN FAN

Education University of Washington

2024–. PhD in *Communication*.

Research interests: Digital media, political communication, computational methods.

Dissertation Title: Everything to do with Politics: Examining Politicization in Online Communities.

Dissertation Committee: Benjamin Mako Hill (Chair), Patricia Moy, Yuan Hsiao, Christopher Adolph.

With a Statistics Certificate.

Expected Graduation Date: Spring 2027

2022–2024. Master of Arts in *Communication*.

Renmin University of China

2018–2022. Bachelor of Arts in *Communication*.

Thesis Advisor: Wenjing Pan.

Publications Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Fan, Y.^{*}, Hill, B. M., & Moy, P. (2026). Unintended politics: Opinion expression and incivility in incidental political discussion. *New Media & Society*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448261441875>

Revision & Resubmissions

Guo, Y. & Fan, Y.^{*} (2026). The politics of the “non-political”: A conceptual review (2004–2024). *Minor Revision & Resubmit: Political Communication*.

Fan, Y.^{*} & Wang-Hai, T. (2026). Motivations and the political correlates of platform migration in international contexts: The case of “TikTok refugees.” *Major Revision & Resubmit: Journal of Information Technology and Politics*.

Fan, Y.^{*} (2026). Political talk in non-political digital spaces. *Major Revision & Resubmit: The Communication Review*.

Under Review

Wang-Hai, T. & Fan, Y. (2026). Behind the Kidney-harvest (Ga Yaozi) Panic: Thailand-Focused Content Creators and the Spillover of Geopolitical Discourse on Chinese Platforms. *Under review*.

Fan, Y.^{*} (2026). Local-Oriented Online Communities as Urban Communication Infrastructure: Evidence from 128 City Communities in North America. *Under review*.

Fan, Y.^{*}, TeBlunthuis, N. & Hill, B. M. (2026). Multilevel Community Ecology: How Relationships Between Digital Groups Are Stronger at Coarser Levels of Analysis. *Under review*.

^{*}Corresponding author.

**Conference
Presentations**

Refereed Paper Presentations (Non-Archival)

- Fan, Y. (2026). Explicating Politicization: Towards a Multi-Dimensional Concept. Paper presented at the *2026 Annual Conference of International Communication Association (ICA)*, Cape Town, South Africa.
- Fan, Y., TeBlunthuis, N., & Hill, B. M. (2026). Multilevel Community Ecology: How Relationships Between Digital Groups Are Stronger at Coarser Levels of Analysis. Paper presented at the *2026 Annual Conference of International Communication Association (ICA)*, Cape Town, South Africa.
- Wang-Hai, T. & Fan, Y. (2026). Behind the Kidney-harvest (Ga Yaozi) Panic: Thailand-Focused Content Creators and the Spillover of Geopolitical Discourse on Chinese Platforms. Paper presented at the *2026 Annual Conference of International Communication Association (ICA)*, Cape Town, South Africa. *Top Faculty Paper Award*.
- Fan, Y. & Wang-Hai, T. (2025). The Political Associates of Platform Migration in International Contexts: The Case of "TikTok Refugees". Paper presented at the *2025 Annual Conference of National Communication Association (NCA)*, Denver, US.
- Fan, Y. (2025). That's What Friendship For: The Potential of Friendship in Connective Action. Paper presented at the *2025 Annual Conference of American Political Science Association (APSA)*, Vancouver, Canada.
- Fan, Y. (2025). Broadcast Information Diffusion Integrates Social Media Discourse: The Moderating Role of Political Penetration in Discussion Contexts. Paper presented at the *2025 Annual Conference of Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)*, San Francisco, US.
- Fan, Y., Hill, B. M. & Moy, P. (2025). Unintended Politics: Partisan Opinion Expression and Incivility in Incidental Political Discussion. Paper presented at the *2025 Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Denver, US.
- Guo, Y. & Fan, Y. (2025). The Politics of the "Non-Political": A Scoping Review (2004-2024). Paper presented at the *2025 Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Denver, US.
- Fan, Y. (2025). Inter-Issue Relationships, Social Group Dynamics, and Politicization in Digital Public Communication. Paper presented at the PhD Symposium of *16th ACM Web Science Conference*, New Brunswick, US.
- Fan, Y. (2024). Towards a Governance Theory of Online Toxicity. Paper presented at *Emerging Media for Communicating SDGs: A Symposium*, Hsinchu City, Taiwan.
- Fan, Y. (2023). Understanding Alternative Political Discourses in Chinese Platforms. Paper presented at the *2023 Annual Conference of the Society for Social Studies of Science (4S)*, Honolulu, US.
- Fan, Y. (2023). Does Incidental Political Discussion Reduce the Polarization of Political Expression? Evidence from Online Communities. Paper presented at the *2023 Annual Conference of the American Political Science Association (APSA)*, Los Angeles, US.
- Fan, Y. (2023). Online Migration in the Political Context: Why do People Migrate

from Mainstream Social Media Platforms to Alternative Ones?. Paper presented at the *2023 Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Toronto, Canada.

Fan, Y. & Hu, J. (2022). Investigating Group Norms in the Digital Age. Paper presented at the *2022 Annual Conference of the National Communication Association (NCA)*, New Orleans, US.

Fan, Y. (2022). Agent-Based Modeling and Communication Studies: A Brief Literature Review. Paper presented at the *2022 Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Paris, France.

Fan, Y. (2021). The Effects of Digital Divide on Citizen Engagement in Local Governance: Based on A Survey on the Audience of Official Accounts Run by Local Government in Ma'an Shan. Paper accepted at the *2021 ICA-affiliated New Media International Conference in SJTU*, Shanghai, China.

Wang, Y. & Fan, Y. (2021). Listening to the Ancient Opera: Linking Media History and Sound Studies. Paper presented at the *Annual Conference of the Chinese Association for History of Journalism and Communication (CAHJC)*, Shenzhen, China.

Methodological training

AI and Computational Methods

AI for social science: LLM-assisted textual analysis; coding-agent-supported research workflows; transformer-based machine learning.

Computational methods: network analysis; computational content analysis; digital trace data analysis; topic modeling; community detection.

Programming languages: Python; R; SQL.

Quantitative Methods

Survey design and implementation; experimental and quasi-experimental design; causal inference techniques; statistical modeling; time-series data analysis.

Qualitative Methods

Interview, participant observation, ethnography, community-based research, qualitative coding, thematic analysis, mixed-methods triangulation.

Teaching

Instructor of Record

2026, Summer (planned). AI and the Business of Media. UW Department of Communication.

2026, Winter. [Online Communities](#). UW Department of Communication.

2025, Summer. Public Speaking. UW Department of Communication.

Teaching Assistant

2025, Autumn, Spring; 2024, Spring; 2022, Autumn. Introduction to Communication.

2025, Winter. Journalism and Public Interest Communication Program.

2024, Autumn. Public Opinion and Public Debate.

2023, Autumn. Communication Technology and Politics.

Mentorship

2026, Winter. Organizing PhD-level Workshop: [Troubleshooting in Computational Research Design](#). Covered topics: AI and LLM for social science, network analysis, computational textual analysis, behavioral analysis, mixed-methods.
2024, Winter. Lindsay Kim. UW undergraduate.

Awards and Scholarships

Fellowships and Recognitions

2026, Spring. Barbara Warnick Dissertation Proposal Award, UW Department of Communication.
2026, Spring. Fritz International Studies Fellowship, UW Graduate School.
2026, March. Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies at George Mason University.
2023, Winter. Top Scholar Fellowship, UW Department of Communication.
2022, Autumn. Provost's Office Top-off Award, University of Washington.

Travel Funds

2025. UW CSSS (Center for Statistics and the Social Sciences) Graduate Student Conference Travel Fund.
2023, 2024. American Political Science Association Travel Fund.
2023, 2025. International Communication Association Travel Fund.
2022–2025. Conference Travel Fund, UW Department of Communication.

Affiliations

Research Affiliations

2022–, Core Student Member, Community Data Science Collective. Service activities included: reviewing work in progress, organizing panels, developing public events, leading retreats, facilitating reading groups, and mentoring junior colleagues.

Professional Organization Membership

2022–, Member, *International Communication Association*. Section Membership: Computational Methods, Political Communication, Organizational Communication.
2023–, Member, *American Political Science Association*.

Service to the Profession

Conference Organization

2025, Dec. Panel Chair and Discussant in *Infrastructure Studies* at STS Junior Scholar conference.
2025, Dec. Discussant at UW Communication Undergraduate Honors Program.
2025, Sept. Panel Chair in *Social Media Engagement and Political Expression* at APSA.
2023, May. Panel Chair in *Political Deliberation and Expression* at ICA.

Peer Review

ICA (International Communication Association) 2022 (2), 2023 (3), 2024 (3), 2025 (7).
NCA (National Communication Association) 2022 (2), 2023 (3).
CHI (ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems) 2024 (1), 2026 (1).